

BONUS GUIDE

The Stitch Deck

25+ Printable Stitch Reference Cards

Your quick-reference guide to every stitch you'll use in paper embroidery. Print, laminate, and keep beside your workspace.

THE EVENING STITCH™

Card 1: Running Stitch

BEGINNER ● ○ ○

What It Is

The simplest stitch — up through one hole, down through the next. Creates a dashed line effect.

Best Used For

Outlines, borders, simple shapes

How To

Even spacing between holes is key. Keep thread tension consistent for a uniform look.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 2: Backstitch

BEGINNER ● ○ ○

What It Is

Go forward two holes, back one. Creates a solid, unbroken line on the front.

Best Used For

Bold outlines, lettering, defining shapes

How To

Work in the same direction throughout. The thread should form a continuous line with no gaps.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 3: Cross Stitch

BEGINNER ● ○ ○

What It Is

Two diagonal stitches crossing in the center of a square of four holes.

Best Used For

Fill areas, decorative borders, traditional patterns

How To

Complete all bottom diagonals first, then all top diagonals — this ensures every cross leans the same way.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 4: Fan Stitch

BEGINNER ● ○ ○

What It Is

Multiple threads radiate from a single point to a row of holes, creating a fan or arc.

Best Used For

Corners, decorative fills, rays of light

How To

Start from the single point each time. Keep thread tension even so all lines are equally taut.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 5: Spiral Stitch

BEGINNER ● ○ ○

What It Is

Holes placed on a spiral curve, stitched in order. Thread follows the spiral path.

Best Used For

Decorative centers, abstract designs, snail shells

How To

Use enough holes (20+) for a smooth curve. Too few holes make the spiral look angular.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 6: Star Stitch

BEGINNER ● ○ ○

What It Is

Points on a circle connected with a fixed skip (e.g., every 5th hole). Creates a star pattern.

Best Used For

Standalone motifs, ornaments, mandalas

How To

The skip number determines the star shape: skip 2 = simple, skip 5 = complex. Experiment!

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 7: Chain Stitch

CONFIDENT ● ● ○

What It Is

Small loops created by bringing the thread back near where it came up, then forward to the next hole.

Best Used For

Textured lines, flower stems, decorative borders

How To

Work slowly and keep loops uniform. Pin each loop in place before moving to the next.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 8: Satin Stitch

CONFIDENT ● ● ○

What It Is

Parallel threads running side by side across a shape, filling it completely.

Best Used For

Filling petals, leaves, geometric shapes

How To

Keep stitches close together with no card showing between. Slight angle changes add dimension.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 9: Whipped Stitch

CONFIDENT ● ● ○

What It Is

A foundation of running or backstitch, then a second thread woven (whipped) around each stitch.

Best Used For

Decorative borders, raised lines, rope effects

How To

Don't pierce the card on the whipping pass — the needle slides under each foundation stitch only.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 10: Seed Stitch

CONFIDENT ● ● ○

What It Is

Tiny random stitches scattered across an area, each just one hole apart.

Best Used For

Background texture, fill empty spaces, add interest

How To

Keep stitches random — if they form a pattern, the effect is lost. Use a lighter thread color than the main design.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 11: Couching

CONFIDENT ● ● ○

What It Is

A laid thread held in place by tiny stitches crossing over it at regular intervals.

Best Used For

Curved lines, decorative outlines, borders

How To

The laid thread stays on the front. The holding stitches should be as small and invisible as possible.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 12: Herringbone Stitch

CONFIDENT ● ● ○

What It Is

Zigzag pattern created by alternating between two parallel rows of holes.

Best Used For

Wide borders, lattice effects, filling bands

How To

Keep the crossing point consistent. The angle of the zigzag determines the pattern width.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 13: Feather Stitch

CONFIDENT ● ● ○

What It Is

Alternating loops on each side of a center line, creating a fern-like pattern.

Best Used For

Botanical designs, decorative lines, branch effects

How To

Alternate sides evenly. Each loop should be the same size for a balanced look.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 14: Blanket Stitch

CONFIDENT ● ● ○

What It Is

Vertical stitches connected by a horizontal bar along the bottom edge.

Best Used For

Edges, borders, decorative finishes

How To

The horizontal bar must lie flat. Work from left to right, keeping vertical stitches even.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 15: Woven Wheel

CONFIDENT ● ● ○

What It Is

Spokes radiating from a center hole, then thread woven over and under alternately.

Best Used For

Flower centers, circular motifs, decorative elements

How To

Use an odd number of spokes (5 or 7) so the weaving alternates correctly on each round.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 16: French Knot

CONFIDENT ● ● ○

What It Is

Thread wrapped around the needle twice, then pushed back through a nearby hole.

Best Used For

Flower centers, eyes, dotted accents

How To

Hold the wraps taut as you push through. The knot size depends on thread thickness and wrap count.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 17: Laced Running Stitch

CONFIDENT ● ● ○

What It Is

Running stitch foundation with a second thread laced through without piercing card.

Best Used For

Decorative borders, wave effects, elegant lines

How To

Use a contrasting color for the lacing. A blunt needle prevents accidental card piercing.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 18: Fly Stitch

ARTISAN ● ● ●

What It Is

A Y-shaped stitch with the tail length varying to create different effects.

Best Used For

Leaves, feathers, scattered motifs

How To

Anchor the tail firmly. Vary tail length to create leaves (long) or scattered dots (short).

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 19: Bullion Stitch

ARTISAN ● ● ●

What It Is

Thread wrapped many times around the needle, creating a coiled tube on the surface.

Best Used For

Roses, caterpillars, heavy texture

How To

Use a milliner's needle (uniform thickness). Wrap firmly but not so tight the needle can't pass through.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 20: Scroll Stitch

ARTISAN ● ● ●

What It Is

Knotted line stitch creating a chain of small knots along a path.

Best Used For

Decorative borders, wave patterns, organic lines

How To

Keep knots evenly spaced. Tension determines whether knots sit tight or loop loosely.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 21: Trellis Stitch

ARTISAN ● ● ●

What It Is

Long straight stitches in a grid, with tiny stitches pinning each intersection.

Best Used For

Large fill areas, lattice backgrounds, basket weave

How To

Lay all horizontals first, then verticals, then pin each crossing. Work methodically.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 22: Raised Cup Stitch

ARTISAN ● ● ●

What It Is

Foundation of spokes with thread woven in circles to form a 3D cup shape.

Best Used For

Dimensional flowers, bowls, berries

How To

The cup rises naturally as you weave. Don't pull too tight or the cup collapses.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 23: Spider Web Fill

ARTISAN ● ● ●

What It Is

Spokes from a center with woven filling, creating a textured circular area.

Best Used For

Large circular fills, mandala centers

How To

Weave from center outward. Alternate over-under on each round. Use odd spoke count.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 24: Drizzle Stitch

ARTISAN ● ● ●

What It Is

A long stitch with smaller loops attached along its length.

Best Used For

Dangling elements, fringe effects, decorative drops

How To

Work from bottom to top. Each loop should hang freely below the main thread.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 25: Knotted Cable Chain

ARTISAN ● ● ●

What It Is

Chain stitch with an additional knot between each link, creating a rope-like texture.

Best Used For

Heavy borders, nautical themes, structural elements

How To

The extra knot adds bulk — use thinner thread (1–2 strands) to keep it manageable.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Card 26: Interlaced Band

ARTISAN ● ● ●

What It Is

Two rows of herringbone with a third thread woven through both, creating a braided band.

Best Used For

Wide decorative bands, Celtic-inspired borders

How To

Complete both herringbone rows before interlacing. The weaving thread should be a contrasting color.

Pro tip: Practice this stitch on a scrap piece of card before using it in a pattern. Five minutes of practice saves thirty minutes of unpicking.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

Your Stitch Reference System

Print these cards, cut them out, and organize them by difficulty level. You can also punch a hole in the corner and keep them on a ring binder at your workspace.

Suggested Practice Order

1. Running Stitch → Backstitch → Fan Stitch (foundations)
2. Star Stitch → Spiral Stitch (first patterns)
3. Cross Stitch → Satin Stitch (filling techniques)
4. Whipped → Chain → Herringbone (decorative lines)
5. Woven Wheel → French Knot (dimensional accents)
6. Artisan stitches (after completing 10+ patterns confidently)

Your Next Step

Pick the first three stitches from the practice order, make a sampler card with all three, and hang it at your workspace as a reminder of what you've learned.

The Evening Stitch™ — Your Next Step Starts Here

